

Feeling of Knowing Forecast Student Handout

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 20-30 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	feeling-of-knowing-forecast

Big idea: The feeling that knowledge is available is itself a judgement that can be tested.

Student-Facing Prompt

Inspect Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Recall prompt: What is the term for a word that imitates a sound?. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Recognition options later: metaphor, onomatopoeia, alliteration, oxymoron. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Feeling of Knowing Forecast Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Recognition options later: metaphor, onomatopoeia, alliteration, oxymoron. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — The feeling that knowledge is available is itself a judgement that can be tested.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students
1	After inspecting Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?
2	Which exact detail from Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus A did you use as evidence?
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?
6	How reliable is introspection as evidence about what we know?

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Recall prompt: What is the term for a word that imitates a sound?
- Recognition options later: metaphor, onomatopoeia, alliteration, oxymoron.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and the Knower.

Activity Steps

1. Ask students to answer short recall questions without options.
2. For unanswered items, students rate whether they would recognize the answer later.
3. Give multiple-choice options for those same items.
4. Students compare feeling-of-knowing forecasts with recognition accuracy.
5. Discuss whether introspection is evidence and when it needs checking.

Observation and Evidence Record

Use this grid to keep observation, inference, evidence, and confidence separate.

What I noticed	What I inferred	Evidence	Confidence

TOK Debrief

- Knowledge question: How reliable is introspection as evidence about what we know?
- What is the difference between not knowing and not retrieving?
- When should a knower trust a feeling of familiarity?

Knowledge Questions

- How reliable is introspection as evidence about what we know?
- Does feeling familiar make a claim more justified?
- How can knowers test their own reliability?

Transfer Example

For example, run this activity with students predict whether they will recognise answers later before seeing options. Have students commit to an initial claim, then reveal the change, hidden rule, alternative context, or comparison that makes the knowledge problem visible.

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...